



Creating a Set List

When crafting a set list, the following elements are essential to keep in mind:

- Audience
- Key
- Tempo
- Feel
- Transitions
- Timbres
- Voice(s)

The best thing to do is watch as many “big box” (major arena) shows as possible and study their performance in great detail keeping in mind all the elements listed above.

- **First impressions count!** You want the first song to start the show off with a bang, with you also want to treat it as a ‘test’ to make sure the sound tech gets the levels right.
- Keep your real opener for the second song.
- Open the show with high energy.
- Save your best song for last.
- The setting of the venue will determine the mood you create.
- Even if your repertoire is diverse, the set should make sense to the listener.
- Plan your transitions.
- Make the transitions gradual in sound and content.
- Plan the stories or jokes you're going to tell.
- Interacting with the audience helps them connect with you and your music.
- **Rehearsing even seemingly small details such as these is what separates the amateurs from the pros.**
- But, remember that things are not always going to go as planned.
- Add in some covers.

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